



**I. Project Title:**

**"EmpowerHER** (E- Enabling, M - Maternal Health, P – Participation, O – Opportunity, W - Women's rights, E – Empowerment, R - Reproductive Health, H - Her, E – Education, R – Rights) **with GAD: Fostering Growth, Awareness, and Development"**

**II. Proponents:**

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**III. Campus:**

Sigma Satellite College

**IV. Rationale**

The **"EmpowerHER with GAD: Fostering Growth, Awareness, and Development"** program at Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College addresses pressing gender and development needs within the community. Through gender sensitivity training, community extension services, and skills workshops, the project aimed to tackle issues such as limited opportunities and empowerment for women, gender-based inequalities, and economic challenges faced by women in the community.

This initiative builds upon previous efforts like the Responsible Parenthood and Teenage Pregnancies Talk, showcasing ongoing commitment to addressing community needs. It is firmly rooted in Philippine laws and policies promoting gender equality, such as the Magna Carta for Women and Gender and Development (GAD) mainstreaming.

The project's relevance to development priorities is evident as it contributes to national goals of inclusive growth, poverty reduction, and women's empowerment. Furthermore, it aligns with Capiz State University's mandate of social responsibility and community development.

Capiz State University's established presence, expertise, and collaborative partnerships provide a comparative advantage in implementing the project effectively. Acting now is crucial to prevent further marginalization of women and promote their immediate socio-economic well-being.



The acronym "EmpowerHER" effectively encapsulates the project's goals, emphasizing empowerment and gender equality. Providing specific data on community challenges and showcasing success stories from past participants would enhance the proposal's impact and effectiveness.

Overall, the "EmpowerHER" project presents a compelling case for implementation by addressing critical needs, leveraging existing efforts, and aligning with development priorities. Acting now can empower women and contribute to a more equitable and prosperous community.

## V. Objectives

The **"EmpowerHER with GAD: Fostering Growth, Awareness, and Development"** of Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College generally aimed to:

*"To enhance the socio-economic well-being and gender equality of the community served by Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College through the "EmpowerHER with GAD: Fostering Growth, Awareness, and Development" Program "*

Specifically, it aimed to:

1. Raise awareness and understanding of gender issues:
  - Conduct gender sensitivity training sessions for various community groups.
  - Educate on topics like responsible parenthood, reproductive health, and women's rights.
  - Promote understanding of color psychology and its application in various contexts.
2. Enhance women's skills and opportunities:
  - Provide skills training workshops in areas like bread and pastry making, cookery and handling safety and sanitation.
  - Offer training on understanding color for handicraft creation, macrame plant hanger and bonsai tree making, crafted beadworks, potentially leading to income generation.
3. Promote participation and active citizenship:
  - Encourage women to participate in community activities and decision-making processes.
  - Offer educational opportunities through the Department of Education Alternative Learning System.
4. Improve maternal health and well-being:
  - Increase awareness of reproductive health issues and responsible parenthood.
  - Connect women with relevant healthcare services and resources.



Overall, the specific objectives work together to achieve the general objective of empowering women in the community and fostering their positive development.

## **VI. Project Description**

**Project ID:** EmpowerHER with GAD: Fostering Growth, Awareness, and Development Program

**Location:** Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College and surrounding adopted communities in Capiz Province, Philippines

**Duration:** September 28, 2021, to present

**Beneficiaries:** Women and community members in Capiz Province, particularly those affiliated or adopted communities of Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College and Department of Education Alternative Learning System – Capiz.

**Results Chain/Framework:** The project aimed to empower women and promote gender equity through various activities focused on maternal health, participation, opportunity, women's rights, empowerment, reproductive health, education, and rights. These activities include gender sensitivity training, skills workshops, educational talks, and vocational training programs.

### **Project Cycle:**

**Needs/Gaps Identified:** The project addresses the need for increased opportunities, awareness, and empowerment for women in Capiz Province, as well as gender-based inequalities and economic challenges.

**Set of Solutions:** The project offers a set of solutions including gender sensitivity training, skills development workshops (e.g., Bread and Pastry Training, Cookery, Food Handling Safety and Sanitation Seminar), educational talks on reproductive health and responsible parenthood, and vocational training programs (e.g., Cookery, Macrame Plant Hanger Making, Bonsai tree Making, Crafted Beadworks Making). These solutions aim to enhance awareness, skills, and opportunities for women, thereby fostering growth, awareness, and development within the community.



### A. Status of the Projects

| No. | Nature of Participation                                                   | Title of Activities, Training, Seminar, Workshop etc.                             | Sponsoring Agency                                                                                                                                           | Inclusive Date                  |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 1   | Resource Speaker and Facilitator: Gender Sensitivity                      | Community Extension Service - Department of Education Alternative Learning System | Community Extension Services Office Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College - Department of Education Alternative Learning System                    | January 22, 2024                |
| 2   | Resource Speaker: Gender Sensitivity Training and Understanding Color     | Gender Sensitivity Training and Understanding Color                               | Community Extension Services Office Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College - Barangay Council of Intongcan (Pontevedra Capiz)                       | August 15, 2023                 |
| 3   | Resource Speaker: Gender Sensitivity                                      | Gender Sensitivity Training                                                       | Community Extension Services Office Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College - Department of Education Alternative Learning System, District of Sigma | July 24, 2023                   |
| 7   | Trainer: Bread and Pastry                                                 | Bread and Pastry Training                                                         | Community Extension Services Office Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College - Overseas Workers Welfare Administration RWO - VI                       | November 18 - December 12, 2022 |
| 4   | Resource Speaker: Gender Sensitivity                                      | Gender Sensitivity Training                                                       | Community Extension Services Office Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College                                                                          | October 3, 2022                 |
| 5   | Resource Speaker: Responsible Parenthood and Teenage Pregnancies          | Responsible Parenthood and Teenage Pregnancies Talk                               | Community Extension Services Office Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College                                                                          | July 19, 2022                   |
| 9   | Resource Speaker: Gender Sensitivity Training and Understanding Color     | Gender Sensitivity Training and Understanding Color                               | Community Extension Services Office Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College                                                                          | June 27 30, 2022                |
| 8   | Facilitator: Conduct of Training on Food Handling, Hygiene and Sanitation | Conduct of Training on Food Handling, Hygiene and Sanitation                      | Community Extension Services Office Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College                                                                          | June 15, 2022                   |
| 9   | Resource Speaker: Gender Sensitivity                                      | Gender Sensitivity Training                                                       | Community Extension Services Office Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College                                                                          | March 30, 2022                  |
| 10  | Resource Speaker: Gender Sensitivity                                      | Training in Cookery                                                               | Community Extension Services Office Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College - Overseas Workers Welfare Administration RWO - VI                       | September 14 - October 5, 2021  |



|    |                                                                    |                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                 |                            |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 11 | Resource Speaker:<br>Understanding Color                           | Training in<br>Understanding Color                                                                | Community Extension Services<br>Office Capiz State University<br>Sigma Satellite College -<br>Provincial Tourism and Cultural<br>Affairs Office | October 6, 2021            |
| 12 | Trainer: Gender<br>Sensitivity Training and<br>Understanding Color | Gender Sensitivity<br>Training and<br>Understanding Color<br>in handcrafted Bonsai<br>Tree Making | Community Extension Services<br>Office Capiz State University<br>Sigma Satellite College                                                        | November 16 -<br>19, 2021  |
| 13 | Trainer: Gender<br>Sensitivity Training and<br>Understanding Color | Gender Sensitivity<br>Training and<br>Understanding Color                                         | Community Extension Services<br>Office Capiz State University<br>Sigma Satellite College -<br>Provincial Tourism and Cultural<br>Affairs Office | September 28,<br>2021      |
| 14 | Resource Person: Skills<br>Training on Macrame<br>Plant Hanger     | Skills Training on<br>Macrame Plant Hanger<br>at Capiz Ecological<br>Park                         | Community Extension Services<br>Office Capiz State University<br>Sigma Satellite College -<br>Provincial Tourism and Cultural<br>Affairs Office | September 28 -<br>29, 2021 |

## VII. Results of Interventions

Based on the activities conducted and the objectives of the "EmpowerHER with GAD: Fostering Growth, Awareness, and Development" program, the results of the interventions can be evaluated as follows:

### 1. Raise awareness and understanding of gender issues:

- Conducted gender sensitivity training sessions for various community groups, including the Department of Education Alternative Learning System Students, barangay councils, and other local organizations.
- Educated participants on topics such as responsible parenthood, reproductive health, and women's rights through talks and training sessions.
- Promoted understanding of color psychology and its application in various contexts to enhance awareness and sensitivity to gender-related issues.

### 2. Enhance women's skills and opportunities:

- Provided skills training workshops in areas like bread and pastry making, cookery, food handling and safety seminar, aimed at enhancing women's skills for income generation and livelihood improvement.
- Offered training on understanding color for handicraft creation, and macrame plant hanger creation, potentially leading to income generation, and increased economic opportunities for women.

### 3. Promote participation and active citizenship:



- Encouraged women's participation in community activities and decision-making processes, fostering active citizenship and empowerment.
- Offered educational opportunities through the Department of Education Alternative Learning System, promoting lifelong learning and empowerment among women in the community.

#### **4. Improve maternal health and well-being:**

- Increased awareness of reproductive health issues and responsible parenthood through talks and training sessions, contributing to improved maternal health outcomes.
- Connected women with relevant healthcare services and resources to address maternal health needs and promote overall well-being.

Overall, the interventions conducted as part of the "EmpowerHER with GAD" project have contributed to raising awareness, enhancing skills, promoting participation, and improving maternal health and well-being within the community served by Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College. These results align with the program's objectives and demonstrate progress towards fostering gender equity, inclusivity, and empowerment.

### **VIII. Lessons Learned**

The implementation of the "EmpowerHER with GAD: Fostering Growth, Awareness, and Development" program has provided valuable insights and lessons learned regarding the connection between and among the participants, partnering agencies, community extension service, implementation, and sustainability of the program.

1. **Connection and Collaboration:** The program facilitated meaningful connections and collaborations between various stakeholders, including community members, partnering agencies, and the university. Through activities such as gender sensitivity training, responsible parenthood talks, and skills workshops, participants were able to interact, share knowledge, and work towards common goals of gender equity and empowerment.
2. **Role of Partnering Agencies:** Partnering agencies, such as the Department of Education Alternative Learning System and the Overseas Workers Welfare Administration – Overseas Family Circle – Capiz Chapter, played a crucial role in supporting and facilitating the implementation of program activities. Their involvement helped broaden the reach of the program and ensure its relevance to the needs of different community groups.
3. **Community Extension Service:** The Community Extension Service Office of Capiz State University Sigma Satellite College served as the primary implementing body for the project. Their commitment to engaging with the community, organizing training sessions, and providing resources contributed significantly to the program's success.





4. **Implementation Challenges:** Despite the overall success of the project, there were challenges encountered during the implementation, such as logistical issues, scheduling conflicts, and limited resources. These challenges underscored the importance of effective planning, coordination, and flexibility in program implementation.
5. **Sustainability:** To ensure the sustainability of the program, efforts need to be made to build on the momentum generated and institutionalize the activities within the community and university systems. This could involve establishing partnerships with local organizations, integrating gender and development initiatives into academic curricula, and empowering community leaders to continue similar activities independently.

In conclusion, the "EmpowerHER with GAD" project has demonstrated the power of collaboration, community engagement, and targeted interventions in fostering growth, awareness, and development. By recognizing and addressing the lessons learned, future iterations of the project can further enhance its impact and contribute to lasting positive change within the community.

## **IX. Recommendations**

1. **Strengthen Partnerships:** Continuously nurture and expand partnerships with various agencies, organizations, and community leaders. This could involve formalizing memorandum of agreements (MOUs) or partnership agreements to clearly define roles, responsibilities, and expectations. Regular communication and collaboration will help ensure alignment of efforts and maximize resources.
2. **Capacity Building:** Invest in capacity building initiatives for both participants and implementing partners. This could include training sessions on project management, gender sensitivity, and community engagement techniques. Building the capacity of stakeholders will enhance their ability to effectively contribute to program objectives and address implementation challenges.
3. **Resource Mobilization:** Explore opportunities for resource mobilization to address logistical issues and resource constraints. This could involve seeking funding from government agencies, non-governmental organizations, private sector partners, and international development organizations. Diversifying funding sources will help mitigate financial risks and sustain program activities in the long term.
4. **Monitoring and Evaluation:** Implement robust monitoring and evaluation mechanisms to track progress, identify areas for improvement, and measure impact. Develop clear indicators and targets to assess the effectiveness and efficiency of program activities. Regular monitoring and evaluation will provide valuable insights for adaptive management and evidence-based decision-making.
5. **Institutionalization:** Work towards institutionalizing gender and development initiatives within the community and university systems.



6. Community Empowerment: Empower community members to take ownership of program activities and initiatives. This could include organizing community forums, establishing women's groups or networks, and providing training on advocacy and leadership skills. Empowering communities will foster a sense of ownership, agency, and resilience, ultimately leading to sustainable change.

By implementing these recommendations, the "EmpowerHER with GAD" project can further strengthen its impact, sustainability, and contribution to gender equity and empowerment within the community.

#### **X. Annexes (Gender and Development Activities Implemented)**







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Photos excerpt during the Training Workshop on Responsible Parenthood and Teenage Pregnancies to the 4P's beneficiaries of Brgy. Mangoso, Sigma, Capiz spearheaded by the Community Extension Service of CapSU Sigma.

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